

**State of Vermont
Secretary of State
Office of Professional Regulation
Board of Allied Mental Health Practitioners**

In re: Saul Stern

License No. N/A

Docket No. 2026-88

STIPULATION AND CONSENT ORDER

STIPULATION

NOW COMES the State of Vermont, by and through Prosecuting Attorney Zoe Newman, and Respondent Saul Stern, by and through his counsel Devin McKnight, Esq., who hereby stipulate and agree as follows:

Board Authority

1. The Vermont State Board of Allied Mental Health Practitioners (Board) has authority to issue warnings or reprimands; suspend, revoke, limit, or condition current licenses or registrations; or prevent the renewal of lapsed licenses or registrations if, after disciplinary hearing, the Board finds that the Respondent has engaged in unprofessional conduct. 3 V.S.A. §129(a); 3 V.S.A. §129a; 3 V.S.A. §814; 26 V.S.A. Chapter 65; the Administrative Rules of the Board of Allied Mental Health Practitioners; and the Rules of the Office of Professional Regulation (OPR).

Stipulated Facts

2. Saul Stern, (Respondent) of Boca Raton, Florida is not currently nor has he previously been licensed by the State of Vermont as a mental health practitioner.
3. Respondent does not nor has he previously held a telehealth registration with the State of Vermont.
4. Respondent is licensed as a Licensed Marriage and Family Therapist (LMFT) by the State of Florida under license number MT3664.
5. On December 3 and 4, 2025, a married couple located in Vermont, herein referred to as the Couple, filled out Respondent's initial intake paperwork in anticipation of beginning psychotherapy with Respondent.
6. In the intake paperwork, both members of the Couple listed Shelburne, Vermont, as their address.
7. Respondent held three telehealth psychotherapy sessions with the Couple, while they remained in Vermont, on December 5, 7, and 9, 2025.

Violation One: 3 V.S.A. §127(b)(2)(A): The Attorney General or an attorney assigned by the Office of Professional Regulation may elect to bring an action seeking only a civil penalty of not more than \$5,000.00 for practicing or permitting the practice of a regulated profession without authority before the board having regulatory authority over the profession or before an administrative law officer.

8. Paragraphs 2 through 7 above are incorporated herein.
9. Under 26 V.S.A. § 4033, a person is prohibited from practicing marriage and family therapy in Vermont without being licensed by the State of Vermont.
10. Paragraphs 2 through 7 above demonstrate that Respondent practiced marriage and family therapy in Vermont without a license when he held telehealth psychotherapy sessions with the Couple, while they were located in Vermont and without first obtaining LMFT licensure or telehealth registration by the State of Vermont, on three occasions: December 5, 7, and 9, 2025.
11. The act(s), omission(s), and/or circumstance(s) described above constitute grounds for discipline because the Respondent has engaged in unauthorized practice of a regulated profession in violation of 3 V.S.A. §127(b)(2)(A).

Understandings

12. Respondent admits the facts above are true and the conditions below are necessary to protect the public
13. Respondent understands that the Board must review and accept the terms of the Consent Order. If the Board rejects any portion, the entire Stipulation and Consent Order shall be null and void.
14. Respondent specifically waives any claim that any disclosures made to the Board during review of this agreement have prejudiced Respondent's right to a fair and impartial hearing if this agreement is not accepted and proceeds to a hearing on the merits before the same Board.
15. Respondent has read and reviewed this entire document and agrees it contains the entire agreement between the parties.
16. Respondent is not under the influence of any drugs or alcohol at the time of signing this Stipulation and Consent Order.
17. Respondent voluntarily enters into this agreement after the opportunity to consult with legal counsel and is not being coerced by anyone into signing this Stipulation and Consent Order.
18. Respondent voluntarily waives the right to a contested hearing before the Board and waives any right to appeal from this Stipulation and Consent Order.
19. Respondent understands that he is responsible for all compliance costs associated with this Stipulation and Consent Order.

20. Respondent agrees the Board may enter the Order set forth below.

Order

Based on the Stipulation above, it is **ORDERED AND ADJUDGED** as follows:

- A. The Board of Allied Mental Health Practitioners hereby **ASSESSES AN ADMINISTRATIVE PENALTY IN THE AMOUNT OF FIVE HUNDRED DOLLARS (\$500.00)]** against Respondent. This penalty is to be paid within **THIRTY (30)** days of the date of entry of this Order.
- B. This Stipulation and Consent Order is a matter of public record and may be reported to other licensing authorities as provided in 3 V.S.A. § 129(a).
- C. This Stipulation and Consent Order applies to all licenses this Board issues to Respondent, including future licenses, as provided in 3 V.S.A. § 129(l).
- D. This Stipulation and Consent Order will remain part of Respondent's licensing file and may be used for purposes of determining sanctions in any future disciplinary matter.

AGREED TO:

Dated: 7/21/2026

**STATE OF VERMONT
SECRETARY OF STATE**

Signed by:
Zoe Newman
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Zoe Newman
Prosecuting Attorney

Dated: 7/21/2026

Respondent DocuSigned by:
Saul Stern
518B6272208A406...
Saul Stern

Dated: 7/21/2026

Counsel for Respondent Signed by:
Devin McKnight
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Devin McKnight, Esq.

APPROVED AND SO ORDERED:

Dated: 8/20/2026

**Vermont Board of Allied Mental
Health Professionals**
DocuSigned by:
Robert Dubbenhorst
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Chairperson

Date of Entry: 8/23/26